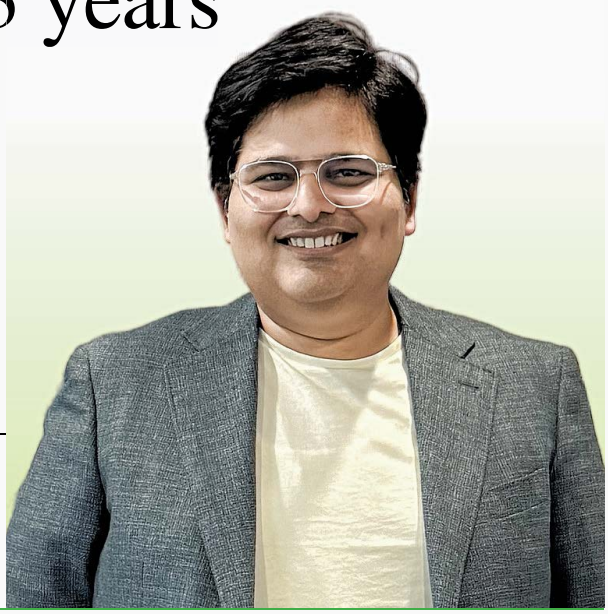
Bootstrapped, Built Bold: How Utkarsh Gupta has built 1000+ Crore business in less than 3 years

Amid India's dependence on crude imports and the underutilisation of agricultural waste, Utkarsh Gupta saw a clear opportunity. In less than three years, he has built Gruner Renewable Energy into one of world's fastest-scaling clean energy platforms without venture capital or investors backing but entirely driven by execution.



Utkarsh Gupta
Founder
Gruner Renewable Energy

Founded in 2023, Utkarsh did not follow the typical startup playbook. With no funding rounds or valuation narratives, the company scaled rapidly through project execution, expanding across multiple states India. Within 3 years, he built a strong pipeline in bioCNG infrastructure valued at ₹4,500+ crore and backed by a growing workforce of 1000+ people. What makes this growth notable is not just its speed, but the discipline behind it. Built entirely as a bootstrapped enterprise in a capital-intensive sector which has grown at CAGR of 114% maintaining positive EBITDA since inception.

A key differentiator for Gruner lies in its shift from pure execution to engineering depth. The company's German Arm-Gruner New Inergie Deutschland GmbH further strengthens this positioning, bringing precision engineering, global expertise and long-term credibility into its operations. ***"With over 25 years of experience and building 500+ biogas plants globally, our aim is to help reshape the Indian biogas sector by applying the best practices, operational excellence, and scalable technologies tailored to local needs" says Mehmet Oenal, COO, Gruner India & Germany.***

The company is bringing advanced global technology into the Indian ecosystem through partnerships and joint ventures with German and Austrian players. These collaborations allow Gruner to integrate proven European engineering standards with Indian execution capabilities. Building on this foundation, Gruner has built its own manufacturing arm as a strategic move to produce critical biogas components reducing import dependency. The approach is clear: import knowledge, not dependency. In doing so, the company aligns closely with the vision of Make in India, moving beyond assembly into genuine technology localisation.

Gruner's model is anchored in its deep integration with rural India through Kisani Urjaa, which goes beyond biomass sourcing to actively reshape the rural economy. Agricultural waste once burnt or discarded is now channelled into a structured energy value chain, reducing environmental harm while creating new income streams for farmers. In its first year alone, Kisani engaged over 30,000 farmers and diverted 20,000 MT of crop residue from burning. This creates a direct, sustainable link between agriculture and energy, positioning farmers as active stakeholders in India's energy transition while improving soil health and income stability***. "We are not just producing energy, we are rewriting the equation of rural India, where waste becomes wealth, farmers become power generators, and sustainability becomes a force multiplier for national growth. Gruner is not a company; it is a platform to power a self-reliant, cleaner India where every village contributes to energy security and every life touched becomes part of the transition," says Utkarsh Gupta, Founder & CEO, Gruner Group.***

Equally transformative is the role of women within this framework. Through a network of over 500+ Kisani Didis, Gruner places women at the forefront of execution driving adoption, awareness and trust at the grassroots. ***"Far from being a peripheral initiative, this is a movement to restore dignity to the farmers while advancing financial independence and leadership among rural women." says Damini Bisht, Co-Founder & COO of Kisani Urjaa.***

In a startup landscape often defined by capital inflow and investor narratives, Gruner stands out for a different reason. It is a bootstrapped company that has scaled by solving real problems on the ground. By connecting farms to fuel, waste to wealth and rural networks to industrial growth, Utkarsh is not just building a business but shaping a new model for India's energy transition one that is rooted in execution, powered by engineering and anchored in the realities of rural India.